



Various Types of Visual Storytelling Techniques and the Pitfalls of Traditional Presentation Methods (1080p) Transcript

Hello everyone, welcome to BITS PLANNING digital, today we will be continuing our learning journey for the course data visualisation storytelling. We will be continuing our model module building dashboards and visual storytelling. In this class, we will be learning about narrative, narrative of how to build your story and what are the different narrative building techniques and what are the 7 different types of stories, data part, what are the different types of narratives that are there and how you can use the 7 different types of data stories to build your narrative and deliver a good data visualisation story.

Now we will understand how storytelling matters in a business context. Why does business storytelling matters? Even in the most objective boardrooms, business decisions are often emotional, it is therefore important to create an emotional connect with the data that you are presenting to the audience to drive them from insight to action. Even in the most objective boardrooms, emotion is essential to convert insight to action.

Therefore your data visualisation or the point that you are getting across to your board members has to be built around a narrative. The logic and emotion always help in driving clarity and persuasion. The logic and clarity that the story building storytelling bridges the logic and emotion and drives clarity and persuasion.

This helps leaders to communicate their point of view to a broader set of audience and make them believe in the narrative. So, if you want people to take action, you have to embed the story into their head and for this you need a strong narrative and we will see how to build that narrative in today's class. So, what is data storytelling? Data storytelling is nothing but assimilation of data into very efficient visuals that can tell a persuasive story in the context for a group of audience that you are targeting.

For this, you need a very strong narrative on how are you going to tell this story and what are the artefacts, the data visualisations that are you using in the story and in which context you are deriving the audience focus. When all these three elements come together, it becomes a very efficient or very authentic data story that will convey the message in the visuals in a narrative form for a particular context for the audience. And famous examples of the data storytelling and the art of communicating insights is can be found in the New York ah Wall Street Journal, Economist magazine where they build data stories for every story they try to say there will be a visualisation and the narrative around it is so immersive that you get the message very clearly.

Now, let me tell you a data story. The graph that you are looking or the picture that you are looking is one of the first visualisations that was used to tell a story. So, this is London.

So, in good old ah 1854 cholera was a communicable disease, there was a cholera breakout and people were dying and people did not understand how is it spreading and there were many adversary actions that were being taken. Then there was a doctor who plotted the incidence of cholera patients on a spatial map, this is the street and it is the black bars indicated the number of cholera incident cholera affected people and it is observed that the pump that is in the centre is the source for spreading of the infection. Why? Because around the pump you can see greater thickness of bars which is nothing, but reflecting the number of cholera affected people or the effect ah affected households.

So, the pump has become the source for spreading of cholera because once you go away from this pump the clustering has reduced. So, it can be construed or it has construed that pump was the source because those days people used to fetch water from common source and that is how cholera here was spreading prevalently. So, an action was taken.

The point that we have to understand here is there was a real concern cholera spread and it was addressed through a story that was told using a visualisation. This is the power of data story telling when you have a right visual and the context and the narrative you can really make actionable ah actionable insights can transform your insights into right action. Now, we will go into storytelling frameworks and understand the traditional storytelling frameworks.

There are three types of storytelling frameworks one is monomyth, story mountain and nested loops. Monomyth is more of a hero centred story where there is a adventure or a problem that is solved by the hero. So, how does this apply to data story? In this case you have a problem, you have solved the problem and you are showcasing it.

Let us say your turnaround a company or a business strategy ticked, a business transformation was done that is where you use this kind of a storyline that how the narrative goes from finding the problem addressing this implementing finding a solution then that solution addressing the problem. So, the narrative was like the hero comes into picture there is a problem he solves it and he is in a world similar fashion you as a data storyteller or the narrative is like this that you find a business problem showcase the problem through couple of visuals suggest a solution the solution is suggested then you try to showcase the solution. In this you are controlling the narrative and you are guiding the person.

Then story mountain again here it is like you have a beginning then there is an incident or a conflict or a contradiction it goes through a climax then action peters off. This is common in persuasive reports and presentations you try to build a climax and cliff effect and the story peters off from there. The visualisations in this framework will start



with basic presentations then seriously sequentially get complicated then it will peter off showing the final output.

Finally you have nested loops when you have stories within stories this is you iterative analysis where there is interaction between the audience and you are trying to convey the story in multiple forms and building story within story you say building story within story gives the audience a sense of excitement wherein they can get more incentive to hook to the plot. We can use any of this frameworks, but it is important to keep in mind how are who are the audience with whom we are planning to engage.

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